THE LOOKING GLASS BEAUTY SCHOOL

B05 Lesson Plan

Based on The CPD Group lesson plan template. One taught day plus pre-course study and post-course case studies.

Builder Gel Overlay and Short Extension CPD Course | Course author: Jessica Jane Preston | Version 1.4, November 2026 | Continuing Professional Development activity, not a regulated qualification.

Course title	**Builder Gel Overlay and Short Extension CPD Course**
Duration	17.5 hours of learner effort: 2.5 hours pre-course reading and workbook prompts; 7.5 guided learning hours in the classroom (one day); approximately 7.5 hours for three post-course case studies. Matches the hours stated on the accreditation application.
Date	Delivered on demand; each cohort's date is recorded on the register.
Time	09:00 to 17:30, with a 30-minute lunch and two 15-minute breaks.
Venue	The Looking Glass Beauty School, 4a Roushill, Shrewsbury SY1 1PQ: training room within the salon, ground floor, step-free access.
Tutor	Jessica Jane Preston: VTCT Level 2 NVQ Diploma in Nail Services, Award in Education and Training, fourteen years' industry experience, teaching since 2021.
Group size	Maximum four learners per tutor so that every learner is directly observed; each learner brings one suitable adult model for the afternoon.
Health and safety considerations	COSHH assessment and SDS for the course gel, cleanser, dehydrator and acetone available in the room; local extraction at each station; nitrile gloves, eye protection and aprons available; lamps PAT/visually checked before the day; first-aid kit and blood-spill kit in the room; fire exits shown at the start; no food or drink at workstations; learners and models screened for acrylate allergy and skin breaks before any product is opened; heat-spike response taught before the first cure.
Equal opportunity issues	Learners asked at booking and again privately on the day about additional needs. Available: large-print and digital manual for screen readers, coloured overlays, extra time or a reader or scribe for the theory paper, oral answers recorded, extra breaks, one-to-one demonstration, adjustable chairs and lighting. Adjustments change how evidence is given, never the competence or safety standard. The salon is wheelchair accessible. Interpreter arranged where notified in advance.

Aim of the course

To enable qualified beauty and nail professionals to apply, maintain and remove builder gel overlays and short extensions safely and to a professional standard, with a correctly placed apex, full control of curing and the heat spike, and sound consultation, hygiene and record-keeping, so that they can offer the service commercially within their insurance and the law.

Learner objectives (the ten learning outcomes from the manual, Chapter 1)

Obj. no.	**Learner objective**
LO1	Explain the purpose, benefits, limitations and client suitability of builder gel, and compare it with gel polish, hard gel and liquid-and-powder acrylic.
LO2	Identify the structures of the nail unit and recognise conditions that require the service to be adapted, postponed or refused.
LO3	Conduct and record a professional consultation, obtain informed consent and create an individual treatment plan.
LO4	Explain oligomers, monomers, photoinitiators, polymerisation, lamp compatibility, under-curing and the inhibition layer.
LO5	Explain why builder gel carries a heat-spike risk that gel polish does not, and control it.

LO6	Select, handle, store and dispose of products and equipment in accordance with risk assessment, COSHH, manufacturer instructions and current UK requirements.
LO7	Prepare the natural nail without avoidable damage to the plate or living tissue.
LO8	Apply a slip layer and build a balanced overlay with a correctly placed apex, straight sidewalls and an even C-curve.
LO9	Create a short extension on a tip or form within the product's stated capability.
LO10	Infill, rebalance and remove builder gel safely by the method the product requires, and provide appropriate aftercare.

Pre-course (2.5 hours, home study)

Read manual Chapters 1 to 10; complete the four pre-course prompts in Chapter 19 (SDS for the product, lamp details, heat-spike answer, three questions to bring). Checked at registration. Evidence: completed prompts in the learner portfolio.

Taught day

Time	Obj. no.	Content	Trainer activity	Learner activity	Resources	Assessment
09:00	—	Register, welcome, housekeeping (fire exits, breaks, toilets, phones). Tutor introduction and training background. Learners introduce themselves and their experience. Course aims, the ten learning outcomes, how the day and the assessments work. Pre-course workbook prompts collected and checked. Additional needs confirmed privately.	Presentation, discussion	Listening, questions, handing in pre-course work	Manual Ch. 1, slides, register, Form H	Oral questioning on pre-course reading
09:30	LO1, LO2	What builder gel is, benefits and limits, comparison with gel polish, hard gel and acrylic. Nail anatomy recap building on Level 2: the structures to protect, living and non-living tissue. Diseases and disorders: observe, ask, decide, record, refer. Photographs Fig. 2 to 12.	Taught session with images; questioning	Listening, identifying conditions from photographs, group discussion of when to refuse	Manual Ch. 2 to 4, slides, Figures 1 to 12	Direct questioning; identify three conditions and the professional action
10:30	LO3, LO4, LO5	Consultation and consent, treatment planning, Form A walkthrough. Gel chemistry: photoinitiators, lamp compatibility, inhibition layer, under-curing and sensitisation, HEMA and TPO. The heat spike: why builder gel is different, and the exact response.	Taught session, demonstration of a consultation, Q and A	Role-play consultation in pairs on Form A; written answer to the Chapter 5 scenario	Manual Ch. 5 and 6, Forms A and B, Figure 13, SDS for the course product	Peer consultation observed by tutor; questioning on cure and heat spike
11:15	—	Break (15 minutes)				
11:30	LO6, LO7, LO8	Architecture: apex, stress area, C-curve, sidewalls, zones, shapes (Figures 14 to 16). Kit and files (Figure 17). Health, safety and hygiene for builder work; legislation summary. Tutor demonstration: preparation (Figure 18) and full overlay on one hand of the tutor's model, narrated: slip layer, bead, level, flash, full cure, check from every angle, finish.	Demonstration with commentary; learners gather round; questioning	Observing, note-taking, asking questions, identifying the apex from the side and barrel on the demonstration nail	Manual Ch. 7 to 12, Figures 14 to 19, product system, lamp, extraction, models	Oral questioning: where is the apex and why; what would you change if the product flooded the cuticle
12:30	—	Lunch (30 minutes, not counted in guided learning hours)				
13:00	LO6, LO7, LO8	Supervised practice 1: learners prepare and apply a builder gel overlay to one full hand of their model, tutor circulating, correcting hand position, bead size, gap and cure timing. Heat-spike drill: each learner states the response before their first cure.	Supervision, one-to-one correction, prompting	Preparing the nail, applying slip layer and structure, curing, checking from three angles, finishing	Models, product, lamp, files, wipes, cleanser, extraction, Form C	Tutor observation against B04 criteria (formative); learners self-check with Figure 15
14:30	LO9	Short extensions: fitting and blending a tip; fitting a form;	Demonstration,	Fitting a tip and a form,	Tips, adhesive, forms,	Observation; questioning

		building the extension in layers; keeping the apex behind the stress area. Tutor demonstration then supervised practice on two nails per learner.	supervision	building a short extension, checking from the barrel	product, lamp, Figure 20	on length limits
15:15	—	Break (15 minutes)				
15:30	LO10	Infill, rebalance and removal: reducing the old apex (Figure 21), removal by product category, what never to do. Troubleshooting table. Aftercare and the written handout; teach-back activity in pairs.	Demonstration of removal; discussion	Removing the overlay from two of the model's nails by the correct method; teach-back of aftercare	Manual Ch. 14 to 17, acetone, files, wipes, aftercare handout	Observation; teach-back checklist
16:00	All	Practical observation assessment (B04): each learner completes a full overlay on two nails and a removal or infill on one nail of their model while assessed. Theory paper (B02) taken under supervision, 60 minutes, while others are assessed; order rotated.	Assessment, observation, marking	Assessed practical; written paper	B02, B03, B04, models, kit	Summative: B02 marked against B03; B04 scored; feedback given
17:15	—	Feedback and results where marked; case-study brief (three sets, Form D, photographs with consent, due within eight weeks); Form G compatibility record for the learner's own kit; evaluation form and reflective practice form issued; next steps and ongoing support; close.	Feedback, briefing	Receiving feedback, completing evaluation form, asking questions	Forms D, G, evaluation and reflective practice forms, Chapter 18	Evaluation forms reviewed by tutor to improve the course
17:30	—	End of taught day. Guided learning hours: 7.5 (09:00 to 17:30 less 60 minutes of breaks and lunch).				

Post-course (approximately 7.5 hours)

Three complete builder gel services on three different clients or models, each with consultation (Form A), treatment record (Form C), photographs from above, side and barrel with consent (Form B), aftercare, reflection and educator feedback (Form D). Submitted within eight weeks. Certificate issued when theory, practical and all three case studies are satisfactory.